

Maya A. Dalton

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SKILLS

Programming: Proficient – Python, R Programming, LaTeX, GitHub, Microsoft Excel
Efficient – PyTorch, Tensorflow, OCR, Tesseract, SQL

Research: Regression Analysis, Time Series, Machine Learning, Social Network Analysis,
Classification and Clustering, Causal Inference, Statistical Analysis, Data Visualization,
Data Management

EDUCATION

The Pennsylvania State University University Park, PA
Ph.D. in Political Science and Social Data Analytics Dissertation Defense: July 2026
M.A. in Political Science May 2024

Wake Forest University Winston-Salem, NC
B.A. in Politics and International Affairs May 2022

Relevant Courses: Machine Learning, Time Series Analysis, Data Mining, Social and Political Network Analysis, Statistical Methods and Multivariate Analysis for Political Research, Foundations of Data Privacy, Approaches and Issues in Big Social Data

RELATED EXPERIENCE

United States Government

Graduate Intern – Analytical Methodologist May 2025 – August 2025

- Developed methods to add rigor to intelligence analysis and collection.

National Endowment for the Humanities

Pathways Graduate Intern – Office of Data and Evaluation May 2024 – December 2024

- Conducted independent quantitative analysis of federal grant funding patterns using administrative datasets.
- Cleaned, transformed, and validated multi-source grant data to improve consistency and analytical usability.
- Performed exploratory data analysis to identify funding trends and geographic disparities.

National Science Foundation

Graduate Research Fellow 2023 – 2026

- Awarded competitive national fellowship supporting advanced quantitative research and methodological innovation.
- Designed and implemented statistical models to analyze high-dimensional social and administrative datasets.
- Built reproducible analytical pipelines in R and Python, incorporating cross-validation and robustness testing.

Pennsylvania State University

Graduate Assistant University Park, PA
August 2022 – August 2023

- Conducted statistical analysis of survey data using experimental methods to estimate latent political attitudes.
- Cleaned, structured, and analyzed large-scale survey datasets using multivariate modeling and inference techniques.
- Independently assisted and graded undergraduate students in an introductory comparative politics course.

Wake Forest University

Research Assistant Winston-Salem, NC
May 2021 – May 2022

- Collaborated on quantitative research projects analyzing corruption metrics using cross-national panel data.
- Applied principal component analysis (PCA) to construct and validate composite indices.

LEADERSHIP & EXTRACURRICULARS

The Pennsylvania State University

Student Representative, Graduate Studies Committee 2025-2026
President, Graduate Association of Political Science (GAPS) 2024-2025
Vice President, Graduate Association of Political Science (GAPS) 2023-2024

Wake Forest University

Vice President of Member Development, Alpha Delta Pi - Eta Upsilon 2021-2022
President's Aide, Office of the President 2021-2022